

MonerOS

Installation Manual

How to extract, flash, and boot HotWalletOS and ColdWalletOS

Overview

This manual walks you through installing MonerOS: extracting the downloaded files, writing HotWalletOS and ColdWalletOS to separate drives, and booting into ColdWalletOS for the first time.

You'll need two separate storage drives, one for each operating system. Review the hardware requirements in the MonerOS User Manual before you begin.

Before you start: After you finish installation, continue setup using the MonerOS User Manual, which is included with the files you extract in this manual.

Part 1: Download and extract MonerOS

1. Download the MonerOS .tar.gz file.
2. Extract the files using your operating system's built-in tools:
 - Windows: Right-click the .zip file, select Extract All..., choose your destination folder, and click Extract.
 - macOS: Double-click the .zip file (or right-click and select Open). macOS will automatically extract the contents into the same folder.
 - Linux: Right-click the .zip file, select Extract Here (or Extract To... to choose a specific destination).

Note: The extracted folder includes the HotWalletOS and ColdWalletOS image files, along with the MonerOS User Manual you'll need for setup.

Part 2: Install a drive-flashing tool

Next, install a tool to write the MonerOS images to your drives. You can use any flashing tool you're comfortable with. This guide recommends balenaEtcher because it works the same way across Windows, macOS, and Linux.

3. Download and install the version of balenaEtcher that matches your operating system (Windows, macOS, or Linux).

Part 3: Flash HotWalletOS and ColdWalletOS

Flash each operating system to its own drive using balenaEtcher or your preferred flashing tool. Repeat the full process twice: once for HotWalletOS and once for ColdWalletOS.

Important: Flashing erases all existing data on the target drive. Back up anything you need before you continue, and double-check that you select the correct drive.

4. Open balenaEtcher and select **Flash from file**, then choose the .img file for HotWalletOS.
5. Select **Select target** and choose your target drive.
6. Select **Flash!** and wait for balenaEtcher to finish writing and validating the drive.
7. Repeat steps 5 through 7 for the ColdWalletOS .img file, using a second drive.

Tip: Label each drive as you finish flashing it. You'll insert only one drive at a time during setup, and it's easy to mix them up otherwise.

Part 4: Boot into ColdWalletOS

8. After both drives finish flashing, shut down the computer.
9. Insert the ColdWalletOS drive, then turn the computer back on.
10. While the computer starts up, repeatedly press the boot menu key for your motherboard or laptop. Common keys include **F12, F11, F2, and Esc**.
11. Use the arrow keys on your keyboard to select the ColdWalletOS drive from the boot menu.
12. Press Enter to boot ColdWalletOS.

Next step: Continue setup using the MonerOS User Manual, included with the files you extracted in Part 1, to create your vault and wallet.